



Driving in the UK - Court Reports



In these worksheets you will find out what happens when you don't have the correct driving documents.

You will read reports about two people who went to court and you will practise vocabulary to do with driving offences and the law.

You will find the answers at the end of the document.

Read the reports about two people who went to court because they did not have the documents they needed to drive in the UK. We say that they *committed a driving offence*. We commit an offence when we do something that is against the law.

Can you find the answer to this question?

Which document did neither person have?

BROUGHT TO JUSTICE

The following cases were heard at Cardiff Magistrates' Court:

Person A

Person B

[REDACTED] 28,
[REDACTED]
was fined £100 after pleading guilty to driving a Suzuki Vitara on August 5 in Treorchy without insurance. He was ordered to pay a victim surcharge of £15 and had eight points put on his licence.

[REDACTED] 36,
[REDACTED]
[REDACTED] was found guilty in his absence of driving without a licence or insurance. He was handed six penalty points on a provisional licence and banned from driving until he has passed his test. He was also fined £240 with £85 court costs and a £15 victim surcharge.

Images of court reports reproduced with permission from the South Wales Echo November 2011.

Activity One

To drive in the U.K. you must have a valid driving licence, car insurance, Tax and MOT. If you don't have these documents you can be stopped by the police and you may have to go to court.

Find these words in the report and draw a line to match the words to their meaning.

guilty

fined

handed

a victim surcharge

penalty points

court costs

banned

to plead guilty

to find guilty

made to pay some money when you have done something that is against the law

not allowed to do something like driving because you have committed a crime

given; for example "he was *given* 6 points on his licence"

having done something wrong or against the law

to tell the magistrate that you committed the offence

to decide that someone is guilty of committing an offence

points that are printed on your driving licence to show that you have committed a driving offence. If you get 12 points you will lose your licence and you won't be able to drive

money you pay that goes into a fund to help people who are victims of crime

money you have to pay to the court to cover the costs of your case

Activity Two

Answer these questions about the court reports.

1. Which person admitted they had committed the offence? A or B?

2. Which person *was found* guilty A or B?

3. What punishment did person A receive? (tick the correct answer ☒)

- A fine of £15 victim surcharge of £100 and 8 penalty points. ☐
- A fine of £100, victim surcharge of £15 and 6 penalty points ☐
- A fine of £100, victim surcharge of £15 and 8 penalty points ☐

4. What punishment did person B receive?

- A fine of £240, court costs of £85, 6 penalty points and banned from driving. ☐
- A fine of £85, court costs of £15, 8 penalty points and banned from driving. ☐
- A fine of £100, court costs of £85, 6 penalty points and banned from driving. ☐

Activity Three

In newspaper articles like these we often use the passive.

Example: A man stole the car. (*active*) ➔ The car was stolen. (*passive*)

Read these sentences. Are they passive (write P) or active (write A).

1. The magistrate fined person A £100.

2. Person A was fined £100.

3. Person B was found guilty of driving without insurance.

4. The court found Person B guilty of driving without insurance.

Read these sentences. Can you write a sentence in the passive that means the same?

1. The court gave person B. 6 penalty points on his provisional licence.

Passive:

2. The magistrate banned person B from driving until he passed his test.

Passive:

3. The court ordered person A to pay a victim surcharge of £15.

Passive:

Answers.

Which document did neither person have?

Car Insurance

Activity One

Find these words in the report and draw a line to match the words to their meaning.

guilty	made to pay some money when you have done something that is against the law
fined	not allowed to do something like driving because you have committed a crime
handed	given; for example he was <i>given</i> 6 points on his licence
a victim surcharge	having done something wrong or against the law
penalty points	to tell the magistrate that you committed the offence
court costs	to decide that someone is guilty of committing an offence
banned	points that are printed on your driving licence to show that you have committed a driving offence. If you get 12 points you will lose your licence and you won't be able to drive
to plead guilty	money you pay that goes into a fund to help people who are victims of crime
To find guilty	money you have to pay to the court to cover the costs of your case

Activity Two

Answer these questions about the court reports.

1. Which person admitted they had committed the offence? A

2. Which person *was found* guilty A or B? B

3. What punishment did person A receive? ((tick the correct answer ☒)

- A fine of £15 victim surcharge of £100 and 8 penalty points.
- A fine of £100, victim surcharge of £15 and 6 penalty points
- A fine of £100, victim surcharge of £15 and 8 penalty points ☒

4. What punishment did person B receive?

- A fine of £240, court costs of £85, 6 penalty points and banned from driving. ☒
- A fine of £85, court costs of £15, 8 penalty points and banned from driving.
- A fine of £100, court costs of £85, 6 penalty points and banned from driving.

Activity Three

In newspaper articles like these we often use the passive.

Example: A man stole the car. (*active*) ➔ The car was stolen. (*passive*)

Read these sentences. Are they passive (write P) or active (write A).

1. The magistrate fined person A £100. A
2. Person A was fined £100. P
3. Person B was found guilty of driving without insurance. P
4. The court found Person B guilty of driving without insurance. A

Read these sentences. Can you write a sentence in the passive that means the same?

1. The court gave person B. 6 penalty points on his provisional licence.

Passive: Mr B was given / handed 6 penalty points on his provisional licence.

2. The magistrate banned person B from driving until he passed his test.

Passive: Mr B was banned from driving until he passed his test.

3. The court ordered person A to pay a victim surcharge of £15.

Passive: Mr A was ordered to pay a victim surcharge of £15.